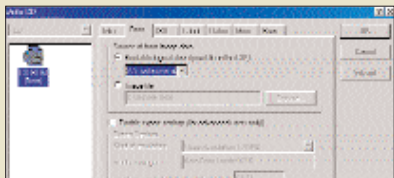


How to Make a Bootable CD using Nero v5.5

Step 1: Get the bootable CD or the floppy of the operating system to make the bootable CD.

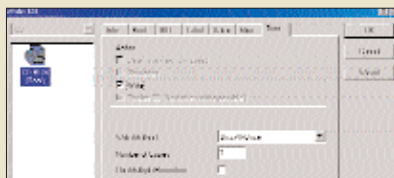
Step 2: Start Nero v5.5 and select the CD-ROM (boot) in the main window. You will be greeted with a new window with an option where you can select the drive in which the bootable floppy/CD is located. Here make sure the bootable floppy is



Select CD-ROM boot in the main Window

in the drive, otherwise the drive letter will not be highlighted.

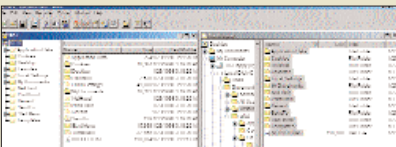
Step 3: Put the blank media in the writer



Select Write and click ok

and leave the ISO and Misc tab as it is. Give the appropriate name in the label section for the bootable CD. Select the Burn tab and check the write and Finalize the CD. Select the Disc-at-Once write method and click on the New tab.

Step 4: Since the bootable CD will be left with lots of unused space, it can be utilised the burning drivers and updates for your PC.



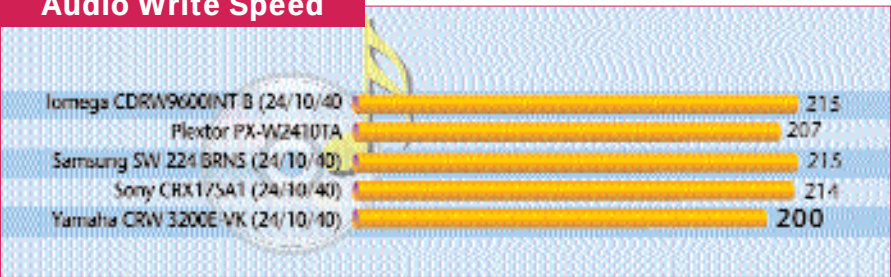
Drag your files into the new window

Step 5: Select the Write tab and in the window which opens, select the safe writing speed according to the configuration of your machine.

Step 6: Now you are ready to write the CD. The typical size of the bootable CD for windows 98SE should come around 125 MB and it will take around 4-5 minutes to complete the process.

Step 7: Check by booting the system with the CD you burned.

Audio Write Speed



all 14 tracks onto the CD in just 200 seconds (3 minutes 20 seconds). It was followed closely by the Plextor PX-W2410TA which clocked 207 seconds (3 minutes 27 seconds). The drive was over 100 seconds faster than all the other 16x drives. To reinforce the Yamaha domination here, the Yamaha CRW 2200 (20/10/40) took a neat 238 seconds (3 minutes 58 seconds) to do the same. Compare this with the scores of other 20x and 24x drives and you will be truly amazed. Nevertheless, the Plextor PX-W2410TA has stuck closely with the Yamaha through the tests and on all occasions has only lost by a hair's breadth.

A score of around 280 seconds is respectable for any 16x drive and you will find that all 16x specified CD writers were more or less in the same league with the fastest being the LG GCE-8160B (16/10/40) which burnt the audio CD in 276 seconds (4 minutes 36 seconds).

Also, all the drives that came in for the test were pretty much adept at handling audio CD writing and none registered any of the quality issues we spoke about earlier.

RAW Write

This benchmark tests the CD-Writer's dexterity in creating coasters. A 700 MB

10 Tips for Maximising CD Writer Performance

- Enable ASPI. ASPI (Advanced SCSI Protocol Interface) drivers mainly consist of the following four files: apix.vxd, apienum.vxd, winaspi.dll, and wnaspi32.dll. These drivers are necessary for the CD writing software to access the CD-Writer.
- Keep your hard drive in top condition by regularly running disk tools like Scandisk and Disk Defragmenter.
- Disable programs running in the background (screensavers, alerts, anti-virus programs, etc) to free up system resources.
- For a CD-to-CD copy, always create an image before writing.
- Keep the firmware versions up to date. Check the manufacturer's Web site for latest updates.
- If you use an ATAPI (IDE) CD-RW drive, make sure it's on a different IDE channel than the hard drive. PCs come with at least two IDE channels (primary and secondary) built into the motherboard. Each channel supports two IDE devices on a single cable: a master and a slave. Hard drives should always be on the primary channel, and ATAPI devices (if any) should be on the secondary channel. Preferably keep your CD writer as the secondary master device.
- Disable auto insert notification from **Start > Setting > Control Panel > System > Device Manager > CD ROM > Device Name > Settings**
- Windows 98 users can increase the disk cache for frequently used hard-disk data. Select **Start > Settings > Control Panel**, double-click the System icon, choose the Performance tab, select File System, click the Hard Disk tab, and under 'Typical role of this computer', change 'Desktop computer' to 'Network server'.
- If you need to burn a CD while you are still on the network, disable File and Print Sharing under Network Properties so as to prevent other users from accessing your hard drive.
- Enable DMA (direct memory access) from **Start > Setting > Control Panel > System > Device Manager > CD ROM > Device Name > Setting > DMA**. This helps the device to directly talk to the hard drive rather than going through the CPU and then accessing the drive.